Guiding questions

GEOTEC Journal Club

GEOTEC research group

2026-11-05

Everyone reads the paper, not only the facilitator. Use these questions **while reading** and bring at least one question or critique to the session; the facilitator uses them to moderate the critical discussion (see the charter).

Scientific contribution

- What is the research question, and why does it matter?
- What is the claimed contribution, and is it new relative to prior work?
- Is the data appropriate? How was it collected and preprocessed?
- Are the methods sound? What assumptions are hidden?
- Do the results support the conclusions?
- What is reproducible? Are code and data available?
- What would we do differently, or how could we use this?

GIScience or spatial checks

> **Note**
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> For papers with spatial data or methods, you may also ask:

Scale and MAUP
: Would results change with a different spatial unit or resolution?

Validation
: Does it account for spatial autocorrelation (spatial vs. random cross-validation)?

CRS and resolution
: Are coordinate reference system and resolution choices justified?

Generalisation
: Would the findings transfer to other regions?

Writing style

- Do the title and abstract state the contribution clearly?
- Does the introduction motivate the problem and position it in the literature?
- Can you follow the methods well enough to replicate them?

- Do figures and tables carry the argument on their own?
- Are limitations stated honestly?
- What would you borrow from or avoid in this paper when writing your own?

Your preparation

Before the session, note:

- ☐ One **strength** of the paper
- ☐ One **weakness** or open question
- ☐ One thing you would **apply** to your own research or writing